

hone your skills and what better way to do that than to sign-up for a competitive service like the ones we are going to be speaking of.

1. CodeChef

CodeChef is global is competitive programming platform that hosts competition in 35 programming languages for students and soft-

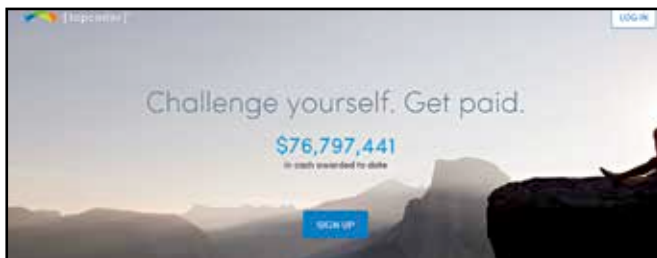


CodeChef's monthly cook-offs are to die for

ware developers. If you feel that you are not yet ready to compete, go through the Practice section and brush up your skills. Like all other platforms, they have problems across varying difficulty levels.

2. TopCoder

TopCoder holds an array of competitions for coders which are actually real world problems faced by TopCoder's clients. You can get individual attention of the TopCoder review board for every



Solve real world issues on TopCoder

submission. Their annual tournament – TopCoder Open – is quite popular and is conducted in multiple stages across multiple countries because of its massive scale. Did we mention that you can make a lot of money also?

Learn code while gaming?

Some services have done a pretty good job of gamifying the entire learning process. Here are some good services that have caught our eye.

1. CodeCombat

There is nothing in this world that cannot be made into a game, and CodeCombat is one such service which has made it really easy to learn programming through playing a game. CodeCombat is essentially a role playing game in which you control your character by typing in code. Each stage teaches you a new aspect of whatever language you're currently learning. As the game progresses, newer elements are introduced and the complexity scales accordingly. All basic beginner level syntaxes and algorithms are covered.

2. CodeWars

CodeWars differs from CodeCombat as users are given different tasks with some reference or the other to a Japanese martial art called Kata. Tasks include determining the output of a code, entering the right input code to get a certain output result, creating a function to get desired output and some more. This approach is more challenging and all the more fun since it makes you think of multiple ways towards solving a problem. Even when you Sign Up for the first time, you'll be tested.

Simple projects to practice

So what should you do after learning a new language? Why practise more by making some cool project. Start working on your 'ideas' which are much better than currently existing solutions. Here are some basic projects that are not only easy to implement and debug but will help you strengthen your concepts as well. You should definitely work towards implementing sorting algorithms since they end up being used a lot. Start with simple sorting programs and scale the amount of data you are working with. You should even go ahead and try creating a personal website and squeeze in as much of your newly acquired programming skills into bringing the site to life. If at all things don't go your way, you can always drop in on of the many programming centric forums and initiate a conversation. There you go, you've taken your first step into the programming world, Bleed Binary! >

*Links Inventory



*Wolfram introduces its programming lab

>>Wolfram programming lab enables anyone who wants to learn programming and algorithms.

<http://dgit.in/WolframLab>



*Simple ways to simplify your code

>>Do you think that your code is complex and hard to debug? Avoid common mistakes with these steps.

<http://dgit.in/SimplifyCode>



* Defensive Programming in Python

>>Here are some tips to help you practice defensive programming with Python.

<http://dgit.in/DefensivePython>